Zachary Sedefian

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Education

M.A. Political Science, *Brooklyn College, CUNY* June 2026
Specialization: International Affairs and Global Justice

B.A. Computer Science, *University at Albany, SUNY* 2018

B.A. Linguistics and B.A. Anthropology, *University at Albany, SUNY* 2014

Research & Publications

Sedefian, Zachary. "Killing Data: Military AI in the Russo-Ukrainian War and its Implications for 21st-Century Imperialism." *Socialism and Democracy* 40, no. 3 (forthcoming November 2026). https://doi.org/10.1080/08854300.2026.2744442

Sedefian, Zachary. "Platform Labor as Economic Imperialism: Unequal Exchange and the Challenge of Chinese Digital Sovereignty." *Journal of Labor and Society* 29, no. 3 (2026): 351–384. https://doi.org/10.1163/24714607-bja10227

Research Interests: International and comparative political economy; economic imperialism; science and technology; digital and gig economy; artificial intelligence.

Conference Presentations

Sedefian, Zachary (2026, March). "Peripheralizing the Service Economy: Digital Platforms and the Virtual Mobility Fix." Union for Radical Political Economics, 68th World Social Science Association Conference.

Sedefian, Zachary (2026, January). "Online Labor Platforms as Economic Imperialism: Unequal Exchange in the International Digital Economy." Unequal Exchange in the 21st Century: A Conference on the Political Economy of Imperialism, International Institute of Social History, Amsterdam.

Sedefian, Zachary (2025, November). "Crowdsourcing as Economic Imperialism." APPEAL / LPE Collective, John Jay College.

Editorial & Peer Review Activities

Associate Editor 2026–present
Journal of Labor and Society

Peer Reviewer 2026
Journal of Labor and Society

- Completed three anonymous peer reviews for manuscripts submitted to the journal

Teaching Experience

Adjunct Lecturer, POLS 1002: Introduction to Global Politics Fall 2026
Brooklyn College, CUNY

- Instructor of record for an introductory course on global politics
- Designed lectures, assignments, and course materials covering major theories of international politics, global inequality, and contemporary global issues

Foreign English Instructor, K to 4th Grade 2014–2015

Youfuxijie Primary School, Nanjing, China

Journalistic Publications

Sedefian, Zachary. "CIA Sees Ukrainian Paramilitary Fighters the Way They Saw Right-Wing Cubans in 1959—as Ripe Fodder for U.S. Empire's Dirty Work Across the Globe." *CovertAction Magazine*, September 1, 2026.

Sedefian, Zachary. "Neo-Nazi-Led Units Earn 'E-Points' for Kill Videos that Train a CIA-Seeded AI Weapons Lab." *CovertAction Magazine*, August 12, 2026.

Analytical & Technical Skills

- Data visualization for academic publication: created all figures and graphs for Ness (2026), *Dialectics of Chinese Labor*
- Data analysis and visualization: R, Python, Excel, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator
- Data organization and database management: SQL, NoSQL
- Software engineering: Java, AWS, JavaScript, etc.
- Qualitative and comparative-historical analysis
- Ethnographic and interview-based research methods
- Technical writing and structured analytical reporting
- Experience producing policy briefs, presentations, and research summaries for mixed audiences
- Graduate courses in Global Governance, Modern International Politics, Comparative Politics, Human Rights in Theory and Practice, Global North-South Relations, U.S. Foreign Policy

Additional Research & Analytical Experience

Language Documentation Project 2014
University at Albany, SUNY

- Conducted field data collection and developed a structured linguistic database
- Organized qualitative data for long-term research use and accessibility

Anthropological Fieldwork 2013
University at Albany, SUNY

- Conducted independent ethnographic research using interview-based methods
- Synthesized qualitative findings into structured analytical outputs

Languages

English	Native
Spanish	Fluent / Advanced
Chinese (Mandarin)	Intermediate
Portuguese	Reading proficiency only
French	Reading proficiency only

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineer 2023–2024
Paychex, Rochester, NY

- Developed and maintained large-scale data systems supporting payroll and workforce analytics
- Translated complex data outputs into structured formats for internal reporting and decision-making

Software Engineer 2020–2023

Ford Autonomous Vehicle, Detroit, MI

- Worked with large datasets and real-time systems requiring precision, documentation, and cross-team coordination
- Contributed to system-level analysis and technical reporting in a high-stakes operational environment

Associate Software Engineer 2018–2020

AutoMate Dealership Systems, Albany, NY

- Supported development and maintenance of enterprise software systems
- Assisted in data handling, system documentation, and structured problem-solving workflows

Selected Honors and Awards

Graduate Political Science Award	2026
Most Outstanding Graduating Senior in Linguistics (Francine Frank Award)	2014
Presidential Undergraduate Award for Research	2014
Magna Cum Laude	2014
Dean's List	2011–2014, 2018